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**NEWSPAPER**

**24<sup>th</sup> October, 2017**

**ITEM WISE EDITORIALS**

**43<sup>rd</sup> WEEK**



# JAPAN - PACIFIST CONSTITUTION

**UPSC CSE – GS II**

**GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES OF DEVELOPED  
COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.**



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# NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

**24<sup>th</sup> OCTOBER, 2017**

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## The Abe manoeuvre

With a stronger win, Japan's PM can go ahead with economic and constitutional reform

Prime Minister Shinzō Abe's Liberal Democratic Party has secured a resounding victory for a third term in the poll to the Lower House of Japan's Diet. The development bucks the recent trend in advanced economies of incumbents being returned with much-reduced margins. A vindication of his decision to call elections a year ahead of schedule, the outcome increases Mr. Abe's prospects of winning a third term next year as leader of his conservative party and becoming Japan's longest-serving premier. The deeper import of the verdict, however, lies in the requisite two-thirds mandate to press ahead with plans to revise the country's U.S.-backed post-War pacifist constitution to reflect current geopolitical realities. The prospect of securing such a large majority had seemed in doubt given the public scepticism over amending the charter, coupled with a drop in Mr. Abe's personal ratings. Now, having cleared that hurdle, he would hope to garner support to accord legal status to the Japan Self-Defence Forces, leaving intact the no-war provisions in the 1947 constitution. In this, he would count on the backdrop of escalating tensions over North Korea's nuclear belligerence and China's growing military influence in the region. But public approval of the proposal in a plebiscite will be the all-important challenge. Sunday's verdict was otherwise largely a foregone conclusion, as the charismatic Governor of Tokyo, Yuriko Koike, did not even contest the race from the new platform she had launched, the Party of Hope. In any case, her fundamentally conservative orientation, even on the constitution, left voters with no real alternative. The opposition Democratic Party, facing months of internal turmoil, initially considered fielding candidates under the banner of Ms. Koike's party. But the latter's insistence on a loyalty test for nominees led to a split within the opposition.

With a firm mandate, the government should be able to focus more on the Abenomics strategy to further stimulate growth and demand. A June assessment of the International Monetary Fund points to the country's sustained growth and record unemployment as evidence of the success of the model. Also significant is the Fund's support for the Bank of Japan's continued loose monetary policy in the face of weak demand. Mr. Abe's poll promise to further boost the fiscal stimulus should please critics who say that concerns over public debt were being overplayed. Whereas Mr. Abe is wringing a sharp increase in the controversial consumption tax up to 10% by 2019, the Fund has proposed a more calibrated approach. Such an alternative may be the right course in a country with a declining working-age population, and faced with persistently low consumer spending. Mr. Abe has his eyes set on seeing the country through the 2020 Tokyo Olympics. Japan will by then be a very different country from what it was in 1964, when it first hosted the Summer Games.



## 1 The Abe manoeuvre

Date : 24<sup>th</sup> October, 2017

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### IMPORTANT QUESTION

### ESSAY / MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Japan is planning to modify its pacifist constitution. Discuss various circumstances, which led to the change in the thought process.

**THE HINDU**  
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

**Date : 24<sup>th</sup> October, 2017**





CHINA

North  
Korea

South  
Korea

JAPAN

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

North  
Pacific  
Ocean

East China Sea

Tsushima Strait

**RESOUNDING VICTORY FOR SHINZO ABE**

***Shinzo Abe***

- 1** Shinzo Abe's conservative coalition is on track to win 311 seats in the 465-member Parliament.
- 2** Shinzo Abe is on course to become Japan's longest serving leader.
- 3** He immediately vowed to deal firmly with threats from North Korea that dominated the campaign.



PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM

THE DEFENCE POLICY OF JAPAN SINCE 1945



- Japan was badly battered in the second World War
- It was one of the Axis powers which lost in the second World War .
- Now, its defence forces are 1,50,000 strong.

- ✓ Following World War II, Japanese Constitution came into force on 3<sup>rd</sup> May, 1947.

*It laid emphasis on  
“SELF-DEFENCE DOCTRINE”, which means*

1. Outlaws war as a means to settle international disputes involving the State.
2. International peace based on justice and order.
3. Armed forces with war potential will not be maintained, but only self-defence forces will be maintained.

*It is called “Pacifist Constitution.”*

## PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM

## THE DEFENCE POLICY OF JAPAN SINCE 1945

ARTICLE 9 OF PACIFIST  
CONSTITUTION

- Japan renounced the use of force in the resolution of international disputes and proclaimed never to maintain the forces to protect land, sea and air.
- The charter only made provision for the establishment of Self-Defence Forces (SDF).

RECENT AMENDMENTS  
IN 2015

- It changed to collective self-defence doctrine after the execution of two Japanese hostages by IS in 2015, January.
- As per the collective self-defence doctrine, Japanese forces can join a battle to defend the nation's allies, even where its territory is not at threat.



## PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM



## IMPORTANT ASPECTS

- As we have already stated, Japan has gone for Pacifist Constitution in 1947.
- However, strict commitment to pacifism was diluted, when the 1954 Mutual Defence Assistance Agreement between Tokyo and Washington assured Japan external protection in exchange for installation of permanent US military bases in the country.
- As already stated, subsequent to 2015 executions of two hostages by IS, Japan changed to collective self-defence doctrine.

***Under the changed geo-political circumstances, due to assertive China, unpredictable North Korea, now, Japan will modify its Constitution in 2020 and the future defence doctrine will be unveiled through that constitution in lieu of several piecemeal measures taken during the past 60 to 70 years.***





## IMPORTANT ASPECTS AHEAD FOR MR. SHINZO ABE



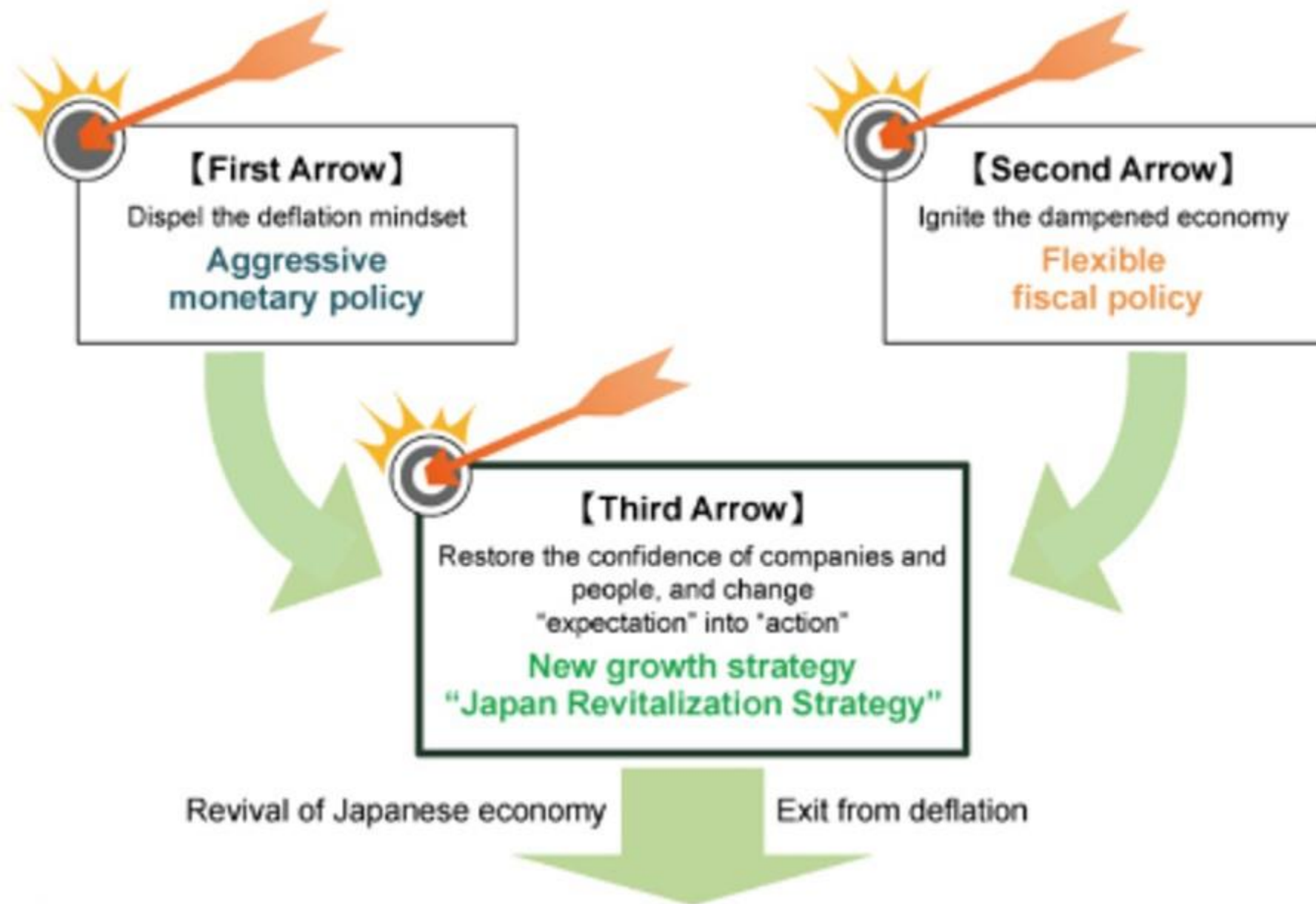
- 1** Plans to revise the country's U.S. backed post-War Pacifist Constitution to reflect current geopolitical realities.
- 2** There are escalating tensions over North Korea's Nuclear belligerence and China's growing military influence in the region.
- 3** Focus by the Government more on the Abenomics strategy to further stimulate growth and demand. IMF also pointed to the country's sustained growth and record unemployment as evidence of success of this model.
- 4** IMF's support for the Bank of Japan's continued loose monetary policy in the wake of weak demand is also significant and Mr. Abe promises to further boost the fiscal stimulus.

***The country is with a declining working-age population, and it is facing persistent low consumer spending. 2020 Tokyo Olympics are going to be held in Japan.***



## ABENOMICS

- 1** It is the multi-pronged economic programme of the Japanese Prime Minister.
- 2** It seeks to remedy two decades of stagnation by increasing the nation's money supply.
- 3** It is also a plan to boost Government spending by enacting the reforms to make the economy more competitive.
- 4** There are three arrows for the Abe's Programme—
  - Printing additional currency between 60 trillion yen to 70 trillion yen to make Japanese exports more attractive and generate modest inflation.
  - The second arrow entails new Government spending programmes to stimulate demand.
  - Reforms of various regulations to make Japanese industries more competitive, which include companies firing ineffective workers.







## STAGNATION

- It is a prolonged period of little or no growth in an economy.
- Economic growth of less than 2 to 3% annually is considered stagnation.
- It is highlighted by periods of high unemployment.
- Stagnation does not constitute a Recession.
- Stagnation can happen within the normal course of the business environment.

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SINCERE THANKS  
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